```
    {
        die($problem);
    }
    return $data;
}
```

We've added an extra parameter to the form: $problem. By default $problem is empty, but if you pass a value for $problem to the function and the length of entered data is 0 the script will stop executing (die) displaying the text passed as $problem parameter.

It's actually easier than it sounds. To validate data from field "yourname" we used this so far:

```
$yourname = check_input($_POST['yourname']);
```

It still works. But if you want to make "yourname" required you now simply add ,"Error message" to the function call, like this:

```
$yourname = check_input($_POST['yourname'],"Enter your name!");
```

Now if the "yourname" fields is empty when the form is submitted, the script will stop and display "Enter your name!" text.As easy as that, for optional fields use

```
$test = check_input($_POST['test']);
```

and for required fields add a comma and an error message before):

```
$test = check_input($_POST['test'], "My error message");
```

Here is the final code of our myform.php script where "Your name", and "Comments" fields are required, but "Your **e-mail**" field is not. If the name is missing you will get an error saying "Enter your name" and if the comments are .missing you will get "Write your comments" error message

```
<?php
$yourname = check_input($_POST['yourname'], "Enter your name");
$email    = check_input($_POST['email']);
$likeit   = check_input($_POST['likeit']);
$comments = check_input($_POST['comments'], "Write your comments");
```

Keyword

E-mail is a method of exchanging messages ("mail") between people using electronic devices.